

## The Clockmaker's Promise

In a quiet village stood an old clock shop, run by a man named Elias. Every clock inside his shop ticked in perfect harmony — except one. A small silver pocket watch on the counter had stopped long ago. Each evening, Elias wound every clock, dusted the shelves, and whispered to the silver watch, “Tomorrow, I’ll fix you.” But tomorrow always came and went. One rainy night, a young boy entered the shop holding a broken wristwatch. “Can you fix this?” he asked. Elias smiled and got to work. As he repaired the boy’s watch, he noticed the boy’s curious gaze on the silver pocket watch. “Why don’t you fix that one too?” the boy asked. Elias sighed. “It belonged to my wife. She passed before I could fix it. I guess... I was afraid it wouldn’t tick without her.” The boy thought for a moment, then whispered, “Maybe it’s waiting for you to try.” Elias smiled sadly, opened the silver watch, and carefully turned the gears. For the first time in years, a soft tick echoed in the room — slow, gentle, alive. Outside, the rain stopped. Inside, every clock ticked together again.